exercises, or combat operations. Weak alignment signals include arms sales, military aid from the United States and its allies, and statements of support for security policies of affected states (or criticism of China). Weak alignment would correspond with conflictive or extensive hedging, depending on the type (offensive or defensive) and volume of weapon platforms purchased or type of statements. Signals of cooperative hedging would be India entering into similar alignment policies with China. Finally, India would be bandwagoning with China if it becomes open to the basing of Chinese troops on its territory or if it enters into a military alliance with China. We should also look for Indian military cooperation with or arms sales to neighbouring countries as signals of alignment and counter-balance vis-à-vis China.

Military and Defence Policies: Liff argues that the metrics for measuring enhancement in military capabilities have to be revised; to measure internal balancing efforts, we should go beyond aggregated numbers on defence expenditure and include elements like, for instance, changes to force posture and pre-positioning of equipment.[63] Sharp increases in defence expenditure, or major changes in defence posture directed towards China, would indicate India balancing China through internal measures. It is more difficult to attribute minor changes in India's force structure or posture to a potential China threat, but changes in the posture along the disputed border with China would be an indicator. If India moves towards more cooperation with China, it would signal this through a reduction in defence expenditure or changes in defence posture away from the border area with China, or it would indicate willingness to accommodate China on the border issue.

Economic Policies: Only a very high degree of economic dependency on the United States or China, or exclusive trade and investment agreements with either of these two countries, would indicate economic balancing or bandwagoning behaviour. Assessing economic factors in